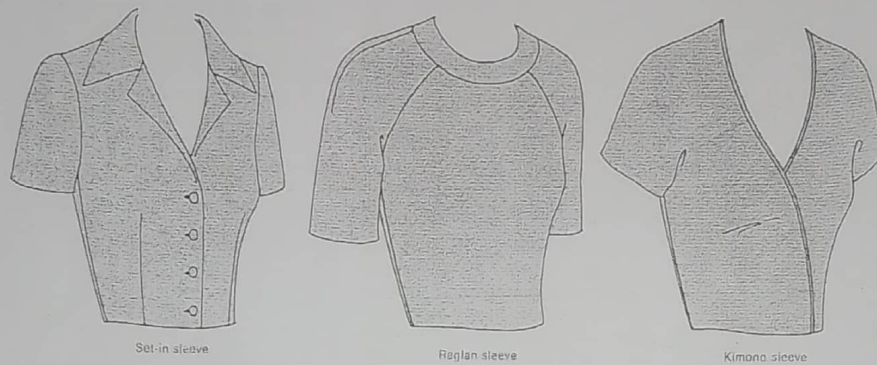


Sleeves: Set –in, raglan and kimono/Magyar sleeve

Introduction

- Well-constructed and correctly fitted sleeves are an important feature of the finished garment.
- The most commonly used sleeve in women's and men's apparel is the set-in sleeve.
- The kimono sleeve and raglan sleeve are often used variations.



[Source: Reader's Digest: Complete Sewing Guide]

Set-In Sleeves

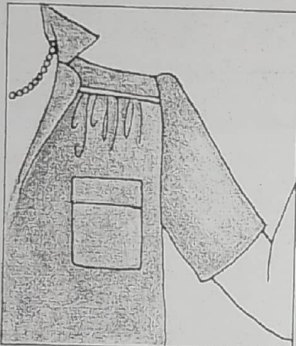
- In a set-in sleeve, the cap fullness is eased into the armhole of the garment.
- The sleeve may be long, short, or three quarter length and finished with or without a cuff.
- A well-made set-in sleeve has the following characteristics.
 - 1) Smooth, rounded cap with no pleats or gathers unless these are fashion features.
 - 2) Ease in the underarm area as well as in the sleeve cap area.
 - 3) Good armhole line resulting from straight, even stitching and well matched seam lines.

Sleeves

Most sleeve styles fall into three basic categories—set-in, kimono and raglan. The techniques given below and on the next pages will help you sew well-made sleeves.

Set-in Sleeves

The rounded area at the top of a set-in sleeve is called the *sleeve cap*. On the sleeve pattern piece, the cap is the curve between the notches, which is designed to fit the shape of your upper arm at the shoulder. When you sew the sleeve in, you ease the sleeve cap into the armhole, creating the rounded shape for your shoulder.

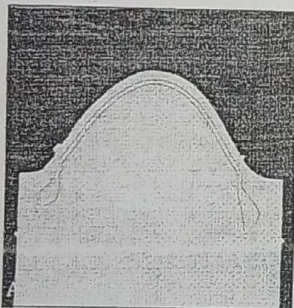


Stitch the sleeve seam and press it open. Then follow your pattern instructions and the information on page 165 to finish the lower edge of the sleeve; it's easier to do this before you sew the sleeve into the armhole.

Turn the sleeve right side out. To pin the sleeve to the armhole, hold the garment wrong side out, with the armhole facing you. Slip the sleeve inside the armhole. Match the sleeve and garment underarm seams, shoulder markings and notches; place pins at these points. Then match the re-

maining markings on the sleeve and the armhole and pin these, too.

Now, pull the threads of the ease stitching at each end. Slide the fabric along the threads. Distribute the fullness evenly in the area between the notches until the sleeve fits the armhole. Pin closely all around the eased area, being careful not to create any puckers. Pin the underarm area between the notches as well (B). If your machine does not stitch over pins, hand-baste close to the seamline and remove the pins before stitching the seam.



In woven fabric: Ease-stitch the sleeve cap twice on the right side of the fabric. First, ease-stitch along the seamline between the notches; then, stitch $\frac{1}{4}$ " (6 mm) away on the seam allowance. Leave thread ends long enough to pull for easing (A).

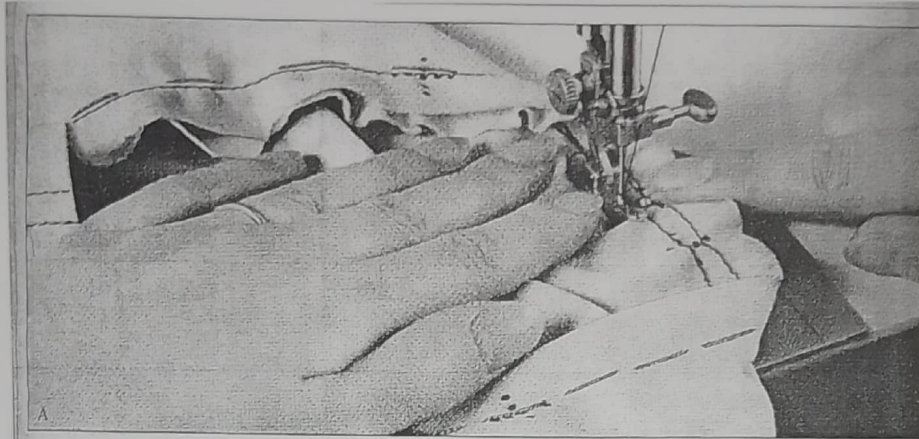
Ease a sleeve cap in a pliable woven fabric just by stitching along the seamline with a regular stitch. While stitching, place one forefinger on each side of the seamline in front of the needle. Pull the fabric horizontally so it is stretched off-grain. At the same time, push it forward under the presser foot for four or five stitches (C). Stop and move to the next section. Continue pulling horizontally, pushing the fabric under the presser foot, and stitching. The sleeve will automatically shape itself into a cap. Then stitch the sleeve to the armhole as described below.



(Source: Simplicity Sewing Book)

Preparing Sleeves

- The sleeves should be carefully fitted, check the location of the elbow darts and the sleeve length.
- After the sleeves are fitted, they should be completely finished before they are permanently stitched into the armhole.



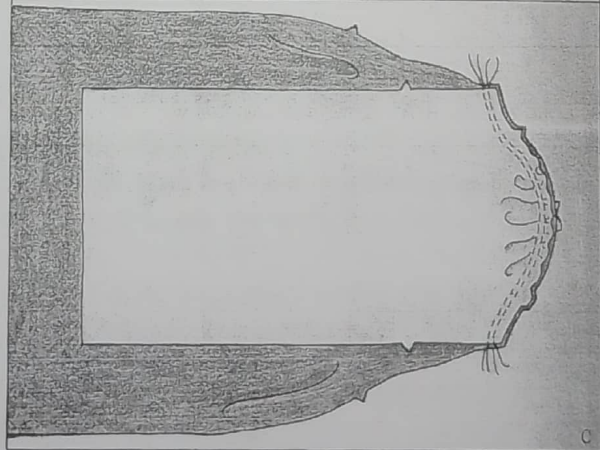
With the sleeve side up, begin at the underarm seam and stitch along the seamline just inside the first row of ease stitching. Use your fingertips to keep the eased area from puckering under the needle (A). Complete the seam by stitching over your first few stitches to secure them. Stitch a second row $\frac{1}{8}$ " (3 mm) away from the first row, on the seam allowance. In the underarm area between the notches, trim close to the stitching (B). Press the seam allowances, not the seam (see page 192).



Easy method: When the sleeve cap has only a moderate amount of ease—as on casual clothes, children's wear or men's shirts—you can stitch the sleeve to the garment while the sleeve is flat, before sewing the sleeve underarm seam and garment side seams.

Stitch the garment shoulder seams only. Ease-stitch the sleeve cap the same as for Set-in Sleeves, on the opposite page. However, don't stitch the sleeve seam.

With right sides together, pin the sleeve to the armhole. Pull up the ease-stitching threads and distribute the ease as for Set-in Sleeves, opposite. With the sleeve side up, stitch on the seamline and again $\frac{1}{8}$ " (3 mm) away on the seam allowance (C). Trim the seam close to the stitching and press it toward the sleeve. *Note:* On a man's shirt, use a flat-felled seam (see page 160). Stitch the garment side seam and sleeve seam in one continuous stitching.



(Source: Simplicity Sewing Book)

To make the sleeve

1. Ease the sleeve cap between notches by making gathering stitches.
2. Stitch under arm sleeve seam and finish seam edge of necessary. Press open.
3. Complete lower edge. The edge can be finished with one of the following finishes:
 - ♦ Hem
 - ♦ Facing
 - ♦ Casing
 - ♦ Cuffs

Stitching Sleeve into armhole

- 1) With RS together fit sleeve into armhole
 - a) Match top of sleeve to shoulder line and sleeve seam to garment seam.
 - b) Match notches (front and back) and pin. Ease the sleeve in between front and back notches.
 - c) Curve armhole seam over hands with fingers against garment and sleeve seam up. Use thumbs to distribute ease and smooth out puckers.
- 2) Hand or pin baste sleeve in place. To pin baste sleeve, place pins parallel to and on seam line.
- 3) With garment on, check the position of armhole seam and grain of sleeve.
- 4) Stitch armhole seam.
- 5) If necessary, for comfort armhole seam allowance may be trimmed to 3/8" between notches at underarm. Do not clip.
- 6) If fabric ravel, overcast or zigzag armhole seam edges together.
- 7) Turn seam allowances of cap portion into sleeve, but do not press. If shoulder pads are to be used fasten, them in place at to at this time.

Kimono Sleeves

- The kimono sleeve is an extension of the bodice.
- It may extend from the bodice side seam in a curve or a sharp angle.
- To prevent garment from leaning under the arms, the angle of the curve is generally reinforced with a stay or a gusset.
- Gussets are used in kimono sleeves for a maximum motion and comfort, also.

A well-made kimono sleeve has the following characteristics.

1. Gusset or reinforcement at the curve or angle of the underarm seam.
2. No drawing or pulling in the underarm area.
3. No ripping or pulling of the upper seam.

Kimono sleeve with underarms stay: -

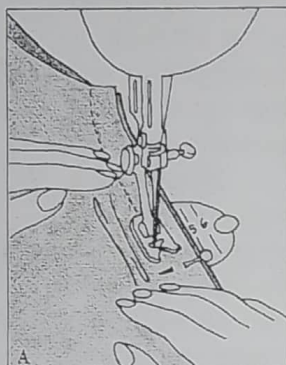
- The kimono sleeve that is not finished with a gusset must be clipped to the seam line along the underarm curve to prevent the garment from puckering.
- If the clipped curve is not reinforced, the garment will tear during normal wear.

Kimono sleeve with gusset

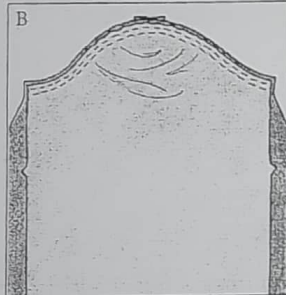
A gusset is a bias piece of garment fabric inserted in the underarm area of a kimono sleeve.

Set-in sleeve for knit fabric:

There's no need to ease-stitch the sleeve cap on knit fabric. Stitch the sleeve to the garment before the underarm and side seams are stitched. Pin the sleeve to the armhole edge, matching notches and markings. Then stitch the seam, with the garment side up. As you stitch, stretch the armhole to fit the sleeve so that the sleeve fullness is eased in (A). Stitch



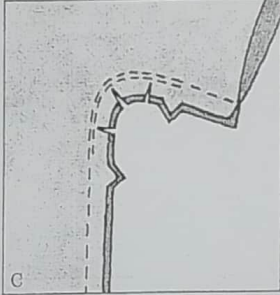
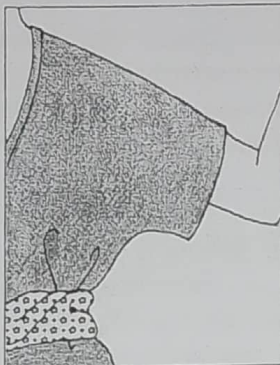
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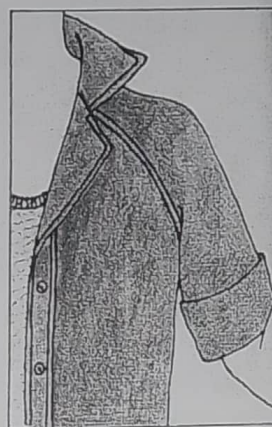
again $\frac{1}{4}$ " (6 mm) away inside the seam allowance; trim close to the second stitching (B). Turn the seam toward the sleeve; press the seam allowances.

Kimono Sleeves

Since kimono sleeves are cut as part of the garment front and back, they're the easiest style of sleeve to sew. Stitch the garment front to the back at the shoulder seams and press the seams open. Finish the neck edge as your pattern directs. Pin the front to the back at the side and underarm seams, matching raw edges, notches and markings. Stitch from the lower garment edge to the edge of the sleeves.



To reinforce the underarm, where there may be some strain, stitch over the first stitching at the curves. Clip the curves (C) and press the seams open. Then finish the sleeve hems as your pattern directs.

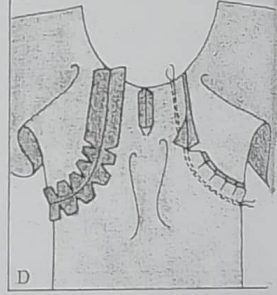


Raglan Sleeves

Raglan sleeves are joined to the garment front and back by diagonal seams running from the underarm to the neckline. These seams are usually stitched before the underarm and side seams.

Preparing: Stitch the sleeve shoulder dart or seam, if any, and press it open; slash the dart to within $\frac{1}{4}$ " (1.3 cm) of the point before pressing.

Stitching: With right sides together, pin the sleeve to the garment front and back, matching



notches and any markings; stitch. To reinforce, stitch over the first stitching. Clip the curves and press the seams open (D). Then stitch the underarm and side seams in one continuous stitching, the same as for Kimono Sleeves. Finish the lower sleeve edges as your pattern directs.

(Source: *Simplicity Sewing Book*)

Raglan Sleeves

- The raglan sleeve extends to the neckline with a slanting seam line from the underarm to the neck in the front and back.

- The raglan sleeve is attached to the garment unit by a seam extending diagonally from the front neckline, under the arm, and diagonally to the back neckline. Therefore, this sleeve forms part of the garment should area.

Construction Procedure

- The raglan sleeve pattern is designed to fit over the shoulder curve by incorporating a dart or a curved seam over the shoulder.
- The darted sleeve pattern is one piece and the shoulder-seamed sleeve is two pieces. Construction procedures for both types are as follows:
 - 1) Stitch shoulder dart, tapering and curving the stitching inward near the dart point. Curving it over the shoulder will prevent the finished dart from protruding outward.
 - Slash the dart and press open or stitch, finish and open the shoulder sleeve seam.
 - 2) Stitch, finish and press the sleeve underarm seam and garment side seam.
 - 3) Pin the sleeve to the garment with RS together, aligning the underarm seam with the side seam and matching markings. Baste and try on the garment to check both garment and sleeve fit.
 - Make any required adjustments
 - 4) Permanently stitch the armhole seam with the sleeve side up. Stitch again between notches $\frac{1}{4}$ " from the first row of stitching.
 - 5) Clip to the seam line at each notch and trim the underarm seam close to the second row of stitching. Edge-finish the seam allowances. Press the seam open above each clip; the seam between notches is left standing.

COLLARS

- Collars are described according to the shape of the neck and outer edges. They vary greatly in shape and size.
- Collars can have pointed (convertible collar) or square (mandarin collar) corners, or they can have a round edge (peter pan collar).
- Collars may be cut as two pieces, as one piece, or with under collar as part of garment section and upper collar as part of facing (shawl collar).
- The techniques used to attach collars vary with the style, and the weight of the fabric.

Characteristics of a well-made collar

- Points, curves and notches are identical on both left and right sides of the garment.
- The ends of the collar do not extend beyond the centre front or back unless specified otherwise by the pattern.
- The collar lies smoothly with none of the under collar showing on the right side.

Flat or partial roll collars

- Flat or partial roll collars with curved front edges are called peter pan collars.
- The collar may be joined to the neck edge with either a fitted neck facing or a bias facing.
- The stitching on the outer edge of the bias facing will be concealed by the collar.

Convertible or Standing (Mandarin) Collars

- The convertible collar is versatile in that it can be worn open or closed.
- In either position, the collar rolls up against the neck; therefore no stitching should show on the RS
- The mandarin collar is a variation of the convertible collar using only the stand of the collar.
- The seam allowances can be turned up between the collar layers because of the collar stand.
- When a garment with a mandarin collar has a back or front zipper placket, the making and attaching of the collar follows the same technique as those for making and attaching cuffs.

Neckband Collar

Tailored shirts often have collars with neckbands. The collar and band may be one piece or the collar may be attached to a separate band.

Shawl Collar

- The shawl collar differs from attached collars because it is an extension of the garment front and not a separate piece.
- The garment fronts extend around the back of the neck and become the underside of the finished collar
- The facings become the upper side of the collar.
- Interfacing is usually attached to the facing (upper collar), but may be attached the garment front for some fabrics.

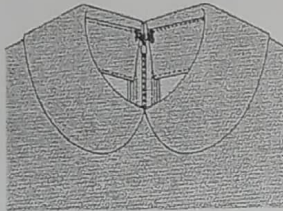
COLLARS

Types of collars

Though they come in many shapes and sizes, all collars are basically one of three types: flat, standing, or rolled. And different as they may be in other respects, collars are alike in one way that is important to understand. Each has a top and bottom portion, usually called the *upper* and *under*

collar, sometimes the *collar* and *collar facing*. It does not matter how the outer edge of a collar is shaped; this shape does not affect its basic construction. The curve of the inner edge, however, is important. It is the relation of the curve at this edge to the neckline curve that determines the

collar's type. The more alike the two curves are, the less the collar will stand up from the neck edge (flat collar). The more these curves differ, the more the collar will stand up (standing collar). If the curves differ slightly, the collar will stand up to some extent, then fall (rolled collar).



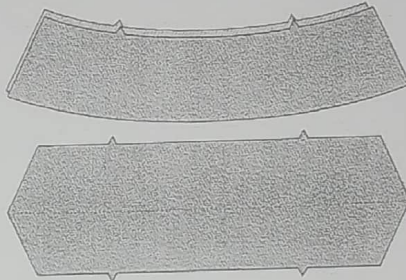
A flat collar emerges from the neck seamline to lie flat against the garment, rising only slightly above the garment's neck edge. A typical example is the Peter Pan collar. Flat collars occur most often in untailored garments, such as dresses, and in children's wear.



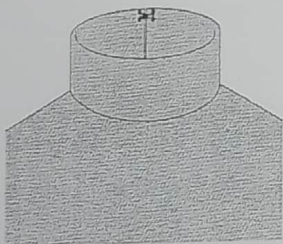
A complete flat collar may consist of two separate units or one continuous unit. When a collar has two units, one is intended for the right-hand portion of the neck, the other for the left-hand portion. The construction of a flat collar is explained on page 214; its application is described on page 215.



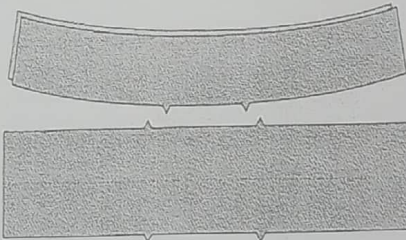
A rolled collar (first) stands up from the neck edge, then falls down to rest on the garment. The line at which the collar begins to fall is called the *roll line*. The positioning of this line determines the extent of the stand, and thus the fall, of the collar. Examples of the rolled collar, other than the one shown, are the notched and the shawl collars.



Roller collars are usually constructed from separate upper and under collars. Some, however, are constructed from one piece that, when folded back onto itself, forms the entire collar. Either type may or may not have a seam at the center back. Construction and application methods for the rolled collar are on pages 216-224.



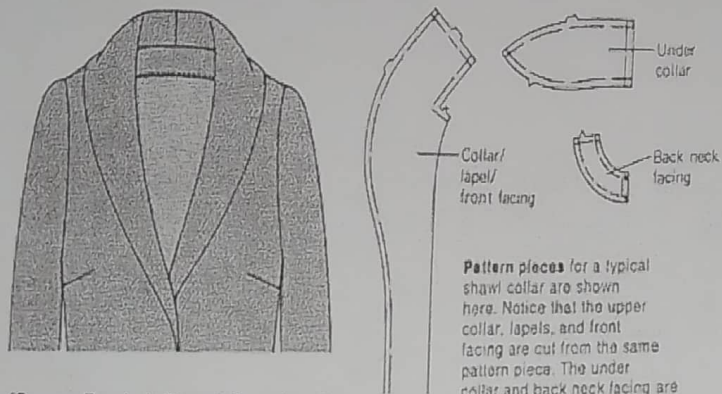
A standing collar extends above the neck seamline of the garment either as a narrow, single-width band or as a wider, double-width band that will fold back down onto itself. Most standing collars are straight, but they can be curved so that they stand up at a slight angle. Shirr collar with a stand is a variation of the standing collar.



A standing collar may be either rectangular or slightly curved in shape. Some have a separate upper and under collar; others are formed from one piece that folds back on itself to form the entire collar. The methods for construction and application of standing collars are detailed on pages 225-228.

(Source: Reader's Digest: Complete Sewing Guide)

Shawl Collar



(Source: Reader's Digest: Complete Sewing Guide)

Pattern pieces for a typical shawl collar are shown here. Notice that the upper collar, lapels, and front facing are cut from the same pattern piece. The under collar and back neck facing are separate pattern pieces.